Local SEO Masterclass

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Ranking a Local Google ...

Introduction to Local SEO

NAP Consistency + Map Emb...

Getting ONLY 5 Star Reviews f...

Getting a Google My Busines...

GMB Location + Direction Ma...

Rank and Rent (Organic S...

Introduction to Rank and Rents

Setting up a Rank and Rent

Ranking your Rank and Rent

Pricing your Rank and Rent

Pitching Rank and Rents

Local SEO for Beginners (...

Introduction

Module 1: Introduction to Loc...

Module 2: Setting Up Your Go...

Module 4: Local Keyword Research



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Overview: Keywords are the search terms people use to find businesses like yours. In this module, you'll learn how to research and identify the best keywords to target for Local SEO. We'll start with the basics of keyword research and then tailor it to local needs – combining services with location terms (e.g. "plumber in Dallas", "best Dallas plumbing service"). You'll discover how to gauge keyword popularity using tools like Google's Keyword Planner, how to "steal" keyword ideas from competitors, and why long-tail keywords (more specific phrases) are often gold mines for local intent.

By the end, you'll have a list of target keywords to drive qualified business traffic.

Example keywords:

Physiotherapy Vancouver

Physio Vancouver

Physio near me

Physiotherapy near me



Module 4: Local Keyword Res…

Module 5: On-Page SEO for Y…

Module 6: Local Business Sch…

Module 7: Key Local SEO Ran…

Module 8: Building Citations

Module 9: Advanced Google …

Module 10: Online Reviews & …

Module 11: Local Link Buildin…

Module 12: Setting Up Analyti…

Module 13: Conducting a Loc…

Module 14: Competitor SEO A…

Module 15: Tracking and Rep…

Module 16: Bringing It All Tog…

Lessons:

1. **Keyword Research Basics** – We introduce why keyword research matters. If you want to attract customers, you need to appear when they search for relevant terms. You'll learn the concept of search volume (how many people search a term monthly) and user intent (what the searcher likely wants). We emphasize focusing on keywords that indicate a *buying intent* – e.g. "buy running shoes Toronto" shows intent to purchase, whereas "history of running shoes" does not. For local SEO, many high-intent queries include a **location or "near me"**, exactly the ones we want.

2. **Using Google Keyword Planner** – A step-by-step on using the free **Google Keyword Planner** tool to gather keyword ideas and data. We show how to access it (via a Google Ads account), enter seed keywords (like the business's services or products), and then filter by the target *geographic location*. This way, you get keyword ideas along with local search volume. For example, a florist in Denver might discover that "flower delivery Denver" has a decent search volume – a strong keyword to target. We discuss analyzing the Keyword Planner results: look for relevant terms with significant volume and note any seasonal patterns (some businesses have peak seasons that show in the monthly breakdown of searches).

3. **Localizing Keywords** – Tips on creating local keywords by combining service keywords with city/neighborhood names. We encourage brainstorming all the ways someone might phrase a local query (e.g. "emergency plumber London", "London 24/7 plumber", "plumber near Paddington"). Even if some terms have lower volume, they can be highly targeted and easier to rank for.

   To streamline this process, we recommend using the **Local Keyword Generator** – just input your services and a list of target locations, and it instantly outputs hundreds of local keyword combinations. It's a fast way to expand your keyword list without missing regional variations.



set up in earlier modules.

4. **Competitor Keyword "Stealing"** – An effective tactic is to see what keywords your competitors rank for. We demonstrate a simple method: plug a competitor's homepage or service page URL into Google Keyword Planner's *Discover new keywords > Start with a website* feature. Google will suggest keywords relevant to that page – which often reveals terms you hadn't thought of. We also mention advanced SEO tools (like Ahrefs, Moz, or SEMrush) that can show competitor keywords if you have access. Even without paid tools, just observing the content and meta tags on competitor sites can provide clues. The idea is not to copy blindly, but to ensure you're not missing important keywords others are targeting.

5. **Long-Tail and Niche Keywords** – We explain the importance of **long-tail keywords** – longer, more specific phrases (typically 3-5 words) that often have lower search volume but **higher conversion rates**. For local businesses, long-tails often include specifics like neighborhoods or detailed service descriptors (e.g. "emergency water heater repair Manhattan"). These may get fewer searches, but the people searching are usually closer to taking action. We encourage you to include a mix of broader keywords and long-tail phrases in your SEO strategy. An added benefit: long-tail keywords are generally less competitive, so a new site can rank for them more easily.

Implementation Steps:

- **Brainstorm Seed Keywords:** List out the core services/products the business offers. For each, think of obvious terms someone would search. For example, if the client is a bakery, seeds could be "bakery," "birthday cake," "fresh bread," etc. Don't filter yourself too much – get a broad list.

- **Use Keyword Planner:** Access **Google Keyword Planner** (via Google Ads). Choose *"Discover new keywords"* and enter your seed terms. Set the location to your city/target area to

keywords. Also note search volumes; prioritize terms that have meaningful volume but are very relevant to the business.

- **Expand with Modifiers:** Take your main keywords and expand them by adding local modifiers (city, neighborhood names, “near me”). For instance, from “bakery,” derive “bakery in [City]”, “[City] bakery”, “best bakery [City]”, “[Neighborhood] bakery”, etc. Use the Keyword Planner again or simply use Google’s own suggestions (type in a partial query and see autocomplete suggestions). Add any promising variations to your list.

- **Analyze Competitors:** Identify one or two top competitors (the ones appearing high when you search your target keywords). Use the Google Keyword Planner’s website input: plug in their site URL to see what keywords Google associates with them. Also manually scan their pages for service names or locations mentioned – you might spot keywords like “emergency plumbing” or “affordable plumber [TownName]” that you hadn’t listed. Add relevant ones to your list.

- **Finalize Your Keyword List:** From all the above steps, compile a master list of target keywords. Group them by intent or type if helpful (e.g., “Main Service Keywords,” “Local (City) Keywords,” “Neighborhood Keywords,” “Long-Tail Questions”). For now, aim for perhaps 10–20 solid keywords/phrases that you will try to rank for initially. You can always expand later. This list will guide your on-page optimization, content creation, and link building in upcoming modules.

Milestone: *By the end of Module 4, you will have a researched list of target keywords for the business.* This list strikes a balance between popularity and relevance – terms your potential customers are actually searching for and for which you have a good chance of ranking. This keyword list will be the backbone of your local SEO campaign: it will inform what you optimize on the website, what content you might create, and

